Beau Elson Fastball HAA Report

Swing/take behavior, handedness split, and similar-LHP benchmark

Fordham Baseball Analytics · 2026 Season

Executive Read

RHH take rate is 50.1% vs 53.6% for similar-stuff LHP. The take rate matters, but it is not the whole issue.

The bigger gap is bat-missing quality: Beau is 13.8% whiff/swing vs 19.7% for peers. Whiff/pitch is 6.9%.

Lefty split is healthier: 23.1% whiff/swing vs 19.7% peer. HAA is steeper to LHH (3.2 deg) than RHH (2.1 deg).

Practical Interpretation

1. More negative RelSide = more 1B-side/crossfire for Beau as a LHP.
2. 1B-side look adds crossfire HAA and projects best for RHH swing/whiff outcomes.
3. Test it, do not assume it: the winning version must keep zone, strike, IVB, and top-zone command.

Key Numbers

Split	Take%	CSW%	Zone%	Whiff	Peer Whiff	HAA	Peer HAA
RHH FB	50.1%	22.3%	56.5%	13.8%	19.7%	2.1	0.7
LHH FB	50.6%	32.9%	54.4%	23.1%	19.7%	3.2	1.3

Before vs Mound-Side Adjustment

What Beau is today, and what could change if the release-side look moves

Current Fastball Profile

Split	Take	CSW	Zone	Whiff	HAA
RHH	50.1%	22.3%	56.5%	13.8%	2.1
LHH	50.6%	32.9%	54.4%	23.1%	3.2

Current mound looks: LHH mean RelSide -3.1 (1B / crossfire); RHH mean RelSide -2.3 (Middle).

Projected Adjustment Effect

Look	Mound	RHH Swing	RHH Take	RHH Whiff	RHH Strike
1B side	1B-side/crossfir	41%	59%	14%	57%
Current	middle	43%	57%	16%	59%
3B side	3B-side/flatter	46%	54%	19%	60%

Projected rates are trained on similar college LHP fastballs. Zone is held constant because release side alone does not move the plate crossing point.

Takeaway

Current problem: against RHH, Beau's fastball is getting taken 50.1% of the time and only missing bats at 13.8% per swing. The peer group with similar fastball traits misses bats closer to 19.7% against RHH.

What the mound-side adjustment could change: the 1B-side/crossfire look can make the fastball arrive from a tougher lane. The updated projection is trained on similar college LHP fastballs, not just Beau's sample.

Coaching test: do not chase angle alone. Test whether the 1B-side setup improves RHH swing quality while holding strike rate, zone rate, fastball ride and top-zone command.

Beau Elson Fastball HAA / Swing-Take Report

Fordham Baseball Analytics. Similar LHP peer group from 2026 college TrackMan data; release-side scenarios are directional.

Observed FB Split

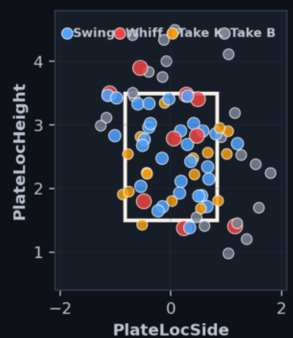
Side	FB	Swing	Take	Take CS%	Whiff	Wh/P	Strike	Zone	HAA	RelS	IVB	Velo
Left	79	49.4	50.6	42.5	23.1	11.4	70.9	54.4	3.2	-3.1	14.5	88.8
Right	377	49.9	50.1	30.7	13.8	6.9	65.5	56.5	2.1	-2.3	15.8	89.1

Coach Read

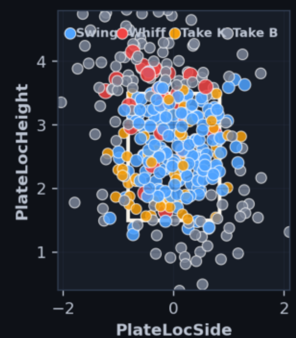
RHH FB read: take rate 50.1%, whiff per swing 13.8%, mean HAA 2.1°. If takes are elevated, whiff/pitch can look worse even when whiff/swing is playable.

Scenario logic: 1B side adds LHP crossfire HAA; 3B side flattens it.
Controls: location, height, count, velo, IVB.

FB vs LHH

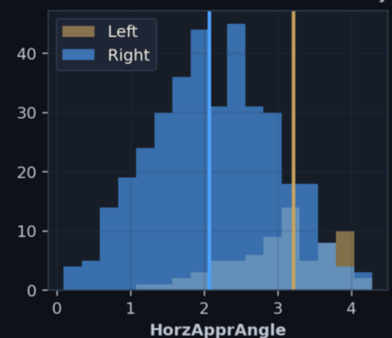


FB vs RHH



HAA Distribution

FB only



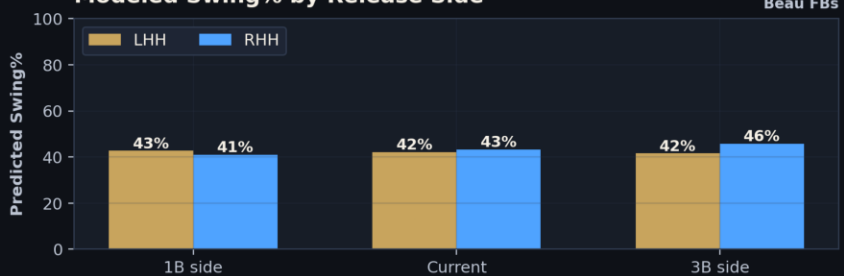
LHP Peer Comp (35 arms)

	Swing%	Take%	Whiff
vs LHH	49% (peer 41%)	51% (peer 59%)	23% (peer 20%)
vs RHH	50% (peer 46%)	50% (peer 54%)	14% (peer 20%)

vs LHH HAA: Beau 3.2° Peer 1.3° ▲2.0°
vs RHH HAA: Beau 2.1° Peer 0.7° ▲1.4°
Green = favorable vs peer · Matched on velo, IVB, spin, ext, rel ht.

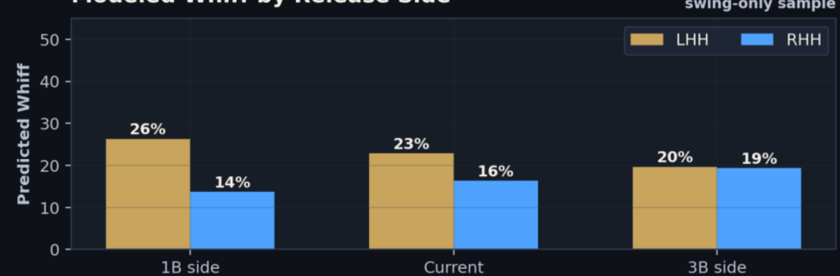
Modeled Swing% by Release Side

Beau FBs



Modeled Whiff by Release Side

swing-only sample



Projected vs RHH by Scenario

Scenario	Mound Look	RHH Swing	RHH Take	RHH Whiff	RHH Strike
1B side	1B-side/crossfir	41%	59%	14%	57%
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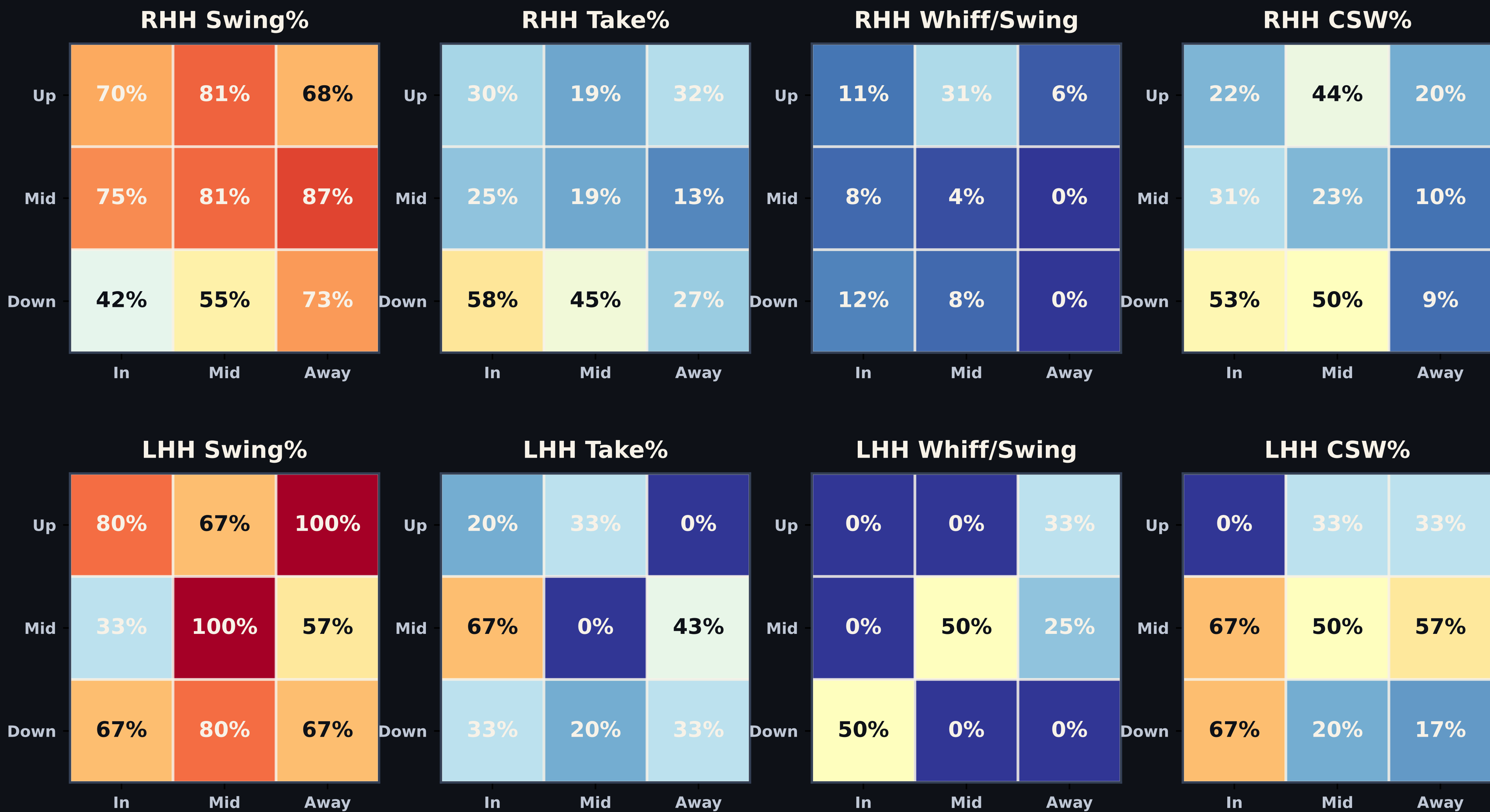
Generated from local Fordham /data CSVs + local 2026 college parquet peers

Fastball 9-Zone Behavior

Where RHH/LHH are swinging, taking, missing, and earning CSW inside the strike zone



9-zone maps use only pitches inside the strike-zone bounds. In/Mid/Away are from the hitter perspective.

How The Report Was Built

Data Pull

Beau sample: local Fordham /data TrackMan CSVs. Filters: PitcherTeam = FOR_RAM, Pitcher = Elson, Beau, pitch type = Fastball/FB/FF.
Peer pool: local 2026 college parquet files. Filters: LHP only, fastballs only.
Samples: Beau 456 fastballs. Peer group: 35 similar LHP, 6,929 fastballs.

Definitions

Swing%: swings / fastballs.   Take%: non-swings / fastballs.
Whiff/Swing: whiffs per swing, or swinging strikes / swings.
Whiff/Pitch: swinging strikes / fastballs.
CSW%: called strikes + swinging strikes / fastballs.
Strike%: called strikes, whiffs, fouls, and balls in play / fastballs.
Zone%: PlateLocSide -0.83 to 0.83 and PlateLocHeight 1.5 to 3.5.

Peer Matching & Model Method

Peer group: every LHP arm with 60+ fastballs matched on velocity, IVB, spin, extension, and release height (35 closest arms). Location confounding fix: HorzApprAngle is residualized against PlateLocSide before entering the model, so the HAA coefficient captures pure approach-angle effect independent of pitch location. HAA × BatterSide interaction isolates handedness-specific sensitivity. Scenario models are then applied to Beau's current locations, counts, and fastball traits.

Concluding Points

Release-Side Scenarios

The release-side scenarios apply a ±1 ft directional shift from Beau's mean release side (-2.5 ft). 1B-side scenario: -3.5 ft (crossfire look). 3B-side scenario: -1.5 ft (flatter look).

For each scenario, theoretical HAA was adjusted geometrically from release side to plate location using extension. A peer-trained logistic model then estimated swing probability, strike probability and whiff probability while controlling for location, height, count, velocity, IVB, release height and extension.

This should be read directionally. It is a coaching experiment guide, not a guarantee that changing rubber position alone will create the exact modeled rates. Projected Zone% is shown as location-held because moving release side does not, by itself, change where the pitch crossed the plate.

Modeled Rates

Look	L Swing	R Swing	L Whiff	R Whiff	L Strike	R Strike
1B / crossfire	43%	41%	26%	14%	61%	57%
Current	42%	43%	23%	16%	60%	59%
3B / flatter	42%	46%	20%	19%	59%	60%

Rubber Recommendation

**vs LHH → STAY on the 1B side / crossfire. Current avg release: -3.11 ft.
Already in the right lane — keep it there.**

**vs RHH → SHIFT to the 3B side / flatter. Current avg release: -2.34 ft.
Target: -1.47 ft (0.9 ft toward the 3B rubber). 3B side is the only scenario that improves swing%, take%, and whiff simultaneously vs righties.**

Guardrail: the 3B shift must hold strike rate, zone rate, and IVB. Test vs live hitters before committing — if any of the three drop, the whiff gain is offset.